Grade 7 • English

Unit 2 — Space

Examination Question Bank

Name: _____ **Class:** _____ **Date:** _____

*This paper covers every lesson of Unit 2 – Space (Coursebook & Workbook, pp. 29–50): 2A how space exploration began, 2B time capsules & the Golden Record, 2C a space journey, 2D what an astronaut does, 2E life on Mars, the Review, and a **Listening** section based on the Unit 2 audio scripts (Tracks 7–12). The full **Answer Key** is at the end.*

How to read this paper: Questions on a shaded amber background marked **[+ extra practice]** are additional items written in the book's style but **not taken directly from the textbook**. All other questions come straight from the Unit 2 material.

SECTION A — Vocabulary: Space & Exploration (Lesson 2A)

Read the definition and write the vocabulary word. (First letters are given as a clue.)

A1. Everything beyond the Earth. (s___)

A2. To send something up into the air. (l___)

A3. Describes the Moon. (l___)

A4. Someone who explores space. (a___)

A5. A long spacecraft that can travel quickly. (r___)

A6. An object sent into space to collect information. (s___)

A7. To bring something down to the ground. (l___)

A8. The activity of going somewhere never visited by humans. (e___)

A9. A small container where astronauts live. (c___)

Complete each sentence with a compound noun.

A10. Astronauts wear a _____ to protect them in space.

A11. A flat surface where rockets are launched into space is a _____.

SECTION B — Vocabulary: Time Capsules & the Golden Record (Lesson 2B)

Match each word to its definition.

Word	Definition
B1. an inch	a. a person who travels to space
B2. clip	b. to look for information
B3. thunderstorms	c. made of gold; gold-coloured
B4. astronaut	d. 2.54 centimetres
B5. disc	e. a person who works in science
B6. research	f. a round, flat item, like a DVD, CD, or record
B7. scientist	g. a short audio or video file
B8. golden	h. bad weather with rain, thunder, and lightning

Complete the facts about the Golden Record with the words from the box.

scientists • golden • disc • astronaut • inch • clips • thunderstorms

B9. In 1977, after years of research, _____ from NASA sent the Golden Record to space on Voyager 1.

B10. This _____ Record was a golden disc sent into space.

B11. The golden _____ is a sort of audio/visual time capsule that contains information about our world.

B12. It was sent with no _____, because humans are still unable to travel great distances in space.

B13. It is a twelve-_____ disc.

B14. There are greetings in 55 languages and sound _____ from Earth, such as wind and rain.

B15. The sounds include wind, rain, and _____ – and even animal noises.

SECTION C — Vocabulary: A Space Journey & Life on Mars (Lessons 2C & 2E)

Match each word to its definition.

Word	Definition
C1. to imagine	a. someone who travels to space
C2. astronaut	b. plants grow from these
C3. seeds	c. to think or dream
C4. science fiction	d. a type of movie or book about space
C5. to be proud	e. to feel happy because you or someone you know did something good

Complete the sentences with the correct word from the box.

planets • temperature • climate • gravity • weather • extreme • condition

C6. The doctor checked the _____ of the sick patients on Mars.

C7. _____ weather on Mars will make it hard for us to survive there.

C8. Earth, Venus, and Mars are types of _____.

C9. _____ is the measure of how warm or cold something is.

C10. Some say _____ change is an important issue on our planet.

C11. If you don't like the rainy _____, you shouldn't go out this evening.

C12. The _____ on both planets is very different: if you weigh 100 lbs on Earth, you would weigh 38 lbs on Mars.

SECTION D — Grammar: The Second Conditional (Lessons 2B & 2C)

Remember: *the second conditional talks about something we imagine (in the present or future, but not real). Form:* **If + past simple, … would + base verb.** *e.g. If I went to space, I would take a camera.*

Put the words in the correct order to make a sentence.

D1. I / to space / would / went / if / I / my camera / take

D2. you / would / go / to Mars / ?

D3. you / would / if / had / a rocket / where / go / ? / you

D4. wouldn't / to the sun / go / I

D5. be excited / a trip to space / would / won / I / if / I

Match the sentence halves.

Sentence half	Ending
D6. If NASA sent out more Voyagers,	a. if another space time capsule were made.
D7. It would be better to use a tablet or computer	b. what would you include?
D8. If you made a space time capsule,	c. if they made another Golden Record.
D9. If I made a space time capsule,	d. they would take many years to travel to the edge of the solar system.
D10. NASA would probably send the same information	e. I would include pictures of Burj Khalifa.

Match the sentence halves.

Sentence half	Ending
D11. If I had one million dirhams,	a. if you had a one-year vacation?
D12. Where would you travel	b. I would ask for their autograph.
D13. If I met my favourite actor,	c. I would take all my friends and family on a nice vacation to the Maldives.
D14. I would do better on my exams	d. if I studied more.

Answer the grammar questions.

D15. How are these two sentences different? (a) If I go to space, I **will** be happy. (b) If I went to space, I **would** be happy.

D16. How do you make a **negative** second conditional? Give the word used in the interview text.

D17. How do you make a **question** in the second conditional? Write one example.

Additional practice — put the verbs in the correct form.

[+ extra practice] D18. If I _____ (have) a spaceship, I _____ (fly) to the Moon.

[+ extra practice] D19. If she _____ (live) on Mars, she _____ (grow) her own food.

[+ extra practice] D20. What _____ you _____ (do) if you _____ (meet) a real astronaut?

SECTION E — Grammar: Compound Nouns & Noun Phrases (Lessons 2A, 2D & 2E)

Join a word from each side to make a compound word, then match it to its meaning.

First word (+ landing / supply / light / ward / flight)	Meaning
E1. lunar	a. the light from the sun
E2. air	b. to land a capsule on the Moon
E3. sun	c. to fly through space
E4. up	d. the air astronauts breathe in the capsule
E5. space	e. to move up

Write the compound noun that matches each definition.

E6. Astronauts do these to research different ideas in space: _____

E7. When there is no force that holds you to Earth: _____

E8. Light that does not come from the sun: _____

E9. The area that is beyond the Earth's atmosphere: _____

E10. Trips astronauts go on to conduct research: _____

E11. A place astronauts live in space and conduct research: _____

E12. The amount of water and sunlight needed for things to grow: _____

E13. The things plants grow from: _____

Match each detail to the correct noun (from "Mars, The Mysterious Red Planet").

Detail	Noun
E14. small, rocky	a. air
E15. extreme	b. Red Planet
E16. covered with rust-like dust	c. wind
E17. can blow over the whole planet	d. Mars
E18. so thin … couldn't even breathe it	e. weather

Put the words in order to make a sentence, then underline the main noun.

E19. moon / The / very / bright / is / tonight

E20. mysterious / very / Mars / is / planet / a

E21. cold is / weather / very / The / there

E22. also / Mars / called / is / Red / the / Planet

SECTION F — Reading Comprehension

Read the interview, then answer the questions. (Coursebook 2C, p. 37)

Celebrity Interview!

Abdulla Al Shamsi is a famous athlete who has written a science-fiction book about living on Mars.

Abdulla, why did you write this book?

"I wanted to make my family proud. I like science fiction and I'm interested in space exploration, so one day I just started writing about it."

Do you think humans will travel to Mars in the next 10 years?

"It's possible. I think we will go when we have the best technology and the best people. The astronauts have to be strong because they might be living on Mars for a very long time. They can't just come back."

If you were an astronaut, would you go to Mars?

"Of course I would. It would be an amazing experience. If I could take my family, it would be even better."

If you went to space, what would you take?

"If I went to space, I would take my camera. The photos would be amazing! Sports would be difficult because the gravity is different. So, I wouldn't take my tennis racket. If I went to Mars, I would take food and seeds. I imagine I would be there for many years. I would grow plants and vegetables on my ship and on Mars. I would also take a notebook and I would write more books."

Do you think you will write another book?

"Yes, if I have time, I will write another science fiction book next year."

F1. What does Abdulla talk about in the interview? (Choose two.)

(a) basketball (b) rockets (c) space travel (d) living on Mars

F2. Why did Abdulla write his book?

F3. When does Abdulla think humans will travel to Mars?

F4. Would Abdulla go to Mars if he had the chance?

F5. What would Abdulla take to space?

F6. Why wouldn't Abdulla take his tennis racket?

F7. What would Abdulla take to Mars?

Read the newsletter, then answer the questions. (Coursebook 2D, pp. 41–42)

The UAE Space Newsletter — Astronaut Mona

The UAE Space Newsletter has an exciting story from our very own astronaut, Mona, who is currently stationed at the International Space Station (ISS) in outer space.

Today was my 8th day at the space station. It has been an exciting trip. My mission is to help conduct science experiments to grow vegetables, like zucchini, in space. This will help future astronauts learn how to grow food on long space missions. So, I have brought many different plant seeds with me. To get to the ISS, we had to get into a big rocket. We were flying over 28,000 kilometres per hour. It is a two-day trip to the ISS. When we arrived, we were greeted by the ISS crew. They were floating in the air because they were in zero gravity.

Now that we have been at the ISS for over a week, I have started my experiments. I am testing how much light and water is needed to grow different plants in space. This is important because long space flights in the future will have a small amount of water and oxygen to grow plants. They will also have a small amount of energy from batteries to use on light. So, it is important that we understand which plant is the most efficient to grow on long space missions.

I planted three plants in three separate pots under the same growing conditions. The first pot is growing zucchinis. The second pot is growing potatoes. The third pot is growing corn. Each plant will receive six hours of sunlight and four centimetres of water. In three weeks, I will write about the results of the experiment…

Update: Each plant has started to grow, though some are growing much quicker than others. The corn plant is growing slowly – it is getting just enough sunlight, but not enough water to grow at a normal rate. The zucchini is receiving enough water and is growing, but because it is not getting enough sunlight, it is growing into very small plants. Zucchini would not be a good food for a long-term space mission; however, it is better than the corn. The potatoes are growing the best – at the same rate as they would in nature. It might be a very important breakthrough. I think we'll make some into French fries for dinner!

F8. Where is Mona stationed?

F9. What is Mona's mission?

F10. How fast was the rocket flying to the ISS?

F11. How long was the trip to the ISS?

F12. What three vegetables did Mona plant?

F13. How much sunlight and water will Mona give each plant?

F14. Which plant grew the best?

F15. Why did the corn grow slowly?

F16. Why did the zucchini grow into very small plants?

Read the text, then answer the questions. (Coursebook 2E, p. 45)

Life on Mars

It is the year 2055 and planet Earth has become over-populated. The solution to this problem is to find a home on another planet. Mars is the choice. Space travel is the new goal for the UAE and our spaceship, Explorer One Dubai, is on its way there now. However, an urgent message was just sent to Mission Control about an engine failure on the spaceship.

F17. In what year is the Mars story set?

F18. What has happened to planet Earth?

F19. What is the solution to the problem?

F20. What is the name of the spaceship?

F21. What urgent message did Mission Control receive?

SECTION G — Listening: Audio Scripts (Tracks 7–12)

Read each audio script below, then answer the questions that follow.

Track 7 — Why space exploration is difficult.

Audio Track 7

Why did it take humans so long to explore space? The answer is that we did not have the right technology to leave Earth. It is difficult for humans to leave Earth. First, gravity keeps everything close to Earth. You can't fly an airplane into space. You need powerful rockets to launch a spacecraft into space. The spacecraft also needs to have very strong walls. A rocket needs strong walls when it launches or it will break apart.

The second problem is that humans cannot live in space. There is no air to breathe and it is very cold. This is why space capsules were invented. Astronauts live in space capsules when traveling in space. Space capsules keep the astronauts alive in space. Space capsules give the astronauts air to breathe. It also protects them from the cold.

G1. Why did it take humans so long to explore space?

G2. What keeps everything close to Earth?

G3. Why must a rocket have strong walls when it launches?

G4. Why were space capsules invented?

Track 8 — The steps of space exploration.

Audio Track 8

Finding out how to send astronauts into space was a difficult and dangerous task. Space exploration happened in several steps.

The first step was to make a rocket strong enough to reach space. Gravity on Earth is very strong, and they needed a powerful rocket engine to bring the spacecraft into space. On October 4, 1957, the first space satellite, Sputnik 1, was launched into space. The satellite studied space and sent back important information to scientists.

The scientists used this information to design a space capsule that would keep people alive in space. The space capsule needed to give air to the astronaut and protect them from the cold. Because it was so dangerous, scientists sent an animal into space first to see if the space capsule worked. On November 3, 1957, Laika the dog was the first animal to be launched into space.

Now scientists knew that the space capsule worked. It was time to send the first man into space. On April 12, 1961, the Russian astronaut Yuri Gagarin became the first man to go into space. He spent almost two hours in his space capsule and landed back on Earth.

The next step was for astronauts to explore other planets and moons. Scientists designed a lunar capsule that could land on the moon. They also designed a spacesuit that would let astronauts walk on the moon. On July 20, 1969, the American astronaut Neil Armstrong did the first lunar landing. He walked on the moon and brought back moon rocks for scientists to study.

The next step in space exploration is to study other planets. Mars is the closest planet. In 2021, the UAE sent a space satellite in orbit around Mars, studying the planet. Maybe one day it will be Emirati astronauts exploring Mars.

G5. What was the name of the first space satellite, and on what date was it launched?

G6. Which animal was the first to be launched into space, and on what date?

G7. Who became the first man to go into space, and on what date?

G8. Who did the first lunar landing, and on what date?

G9. What did the UAE send into orbit around Mars in 2021?

Track 9 — The Golden Record.

Audio Track 9

Nawaf: What are you reading about, Sultan?

Abdullah: Yeah, what are you looking at?

Sultan: I'm doing some research for my science class on space travel.

Abdullah: That sounds boring…

Sultan: Actually, it's pretty interesting. Have you guys ever heard of the Golden Record?

Nawaf: No. What's that?

Sultan: It's an audio/visual time capsule that was sent to space in 1977. Scientists recorded a bunch of information about the world and put it on a 12-inch golden disc to be found in the future.

Abdullah: That is interesting! What type of stuff is on the disc?

Sultan: A lot of different things.

Nawaf: Like…

Sultan: It says here that there are greetings in 55 languages, including Arabic, English, Urdu, and Chinese.

Abdullah: What else?

Sultan: It also says that there are many different sounds recorded from all around the world – sounds like wind, rain, thunderstorms…

Nawaf: …and animals?

Sultan: Yeah, animals too! There are clips of birds, frogs, elephants…

Abdullah: Any pictures?

Sultan: … a picture of the Taj Mahal, the Sydney Opera House, an airplane, an astronaut…

Nawaf: …lots of stuff, then.

G10. What is the Golden Record, and when was it sent to space?

G11. In how many languages are there greetings on the Golden Record?

G12. Name two of the sounds recorded on the Golden Record.

G13. Name two of the pictures on the Golden Record.

Track 10 — A modern time capsule.

Audio Track 10

Abdullah: So why all this research, Sultan?

Sultan: Well, part of my homework is to decide what I would include if I made a time capsule to send to space. Instead of using a record, our time capsule is going to be a tablet.

Nawaf: So, what would you put on your tablet, or, time capsule?

Sultan: A lot of things, but mostly, I would put information about the UAE. In 1977, we were a young nation – a lot has happened since the Golden Record was sent out to space. The first thing on my list would be Burj Khalifa, because it's the tallest building in the world. I would include a bunch of photos and videos, especially ones taken from the top!

Abdullah: Don't forget Sheikh Zayed Grand Mosque! I would include lots of photos of the brilliant architecture.

Nawaf: We would have to have more than buildings, though. What about a video of someone doing falconry? Or the camel races?

Sultan: The truth is that we have so many things here in the Emirates, it would be hard to choose. This is going to be a difficult assignment!

G14. Instead of a record, what will Sultan's time capsule be?

G15. Why would Sultan include the Burj Khalifa?

G16. Which mosque does Abdullah want to include?

G17. What two activities does Nawaf suggest including?

Track 11 — would or 'd?

Audio Track 11

Number 1: Part of my homework is to decide what I would include if I made a time capsule to send to space.

Number 2: What would you put on your tablet, or, time capsule?

Number 3: Mostly, I'd put information about the UAE.

Number 4: I would include Burj Khalifa, because it's the tallest building in the world.

Number 5: I'd also include lots of photos of its brilliant architecture.

Number 6: We'd have to have more than buildings.

G18. In "Mostly, I'd put information about the UAE," what does 'd stand for?

Track 12 — Trouble on the mission.

Audio Track 12

…Alert! Alert! This is Explorer One Dubai… we have had an engine failure and we're going down! I can't control the spaceship! We have reached the orbit of Mars and we are falling fast to the surface of the planet! Our mission is in danger now! …

…mission control, we are all safe but Explorer One Dubai is damaged from the crash. Please send help. For now, we will need to survive here.

G19. What is the name of the spaceship in trouble?

G20. Whose orbit had the spaceship reached?

G21. After the crash, is the crew safe, and what do they ask Mission Control to do?

Match the event to its date on the timeline (Track 8).

Event	Date
G22a. The first satellite is launched into space	1. November 3, 1957
G22b. Laika the dog travels in a space capsule	2. July 20, 1969
G22c. Yuri Gagarin is the first man in space	3. October 4, 1957
G22d. Neil Armstrong is the first man on the Moon	4. April 12, 1961

Extension — use what you heard.

[+ extra practice] GX1. Put these space milestones in the correct time order (1–5): ____ Neil Armstrong's Moon landing ____ Sputnik 1 launched ____ UAE Mars satellite ____ Yuri Gagarin in space ____ Laika the dog in space.

[+ extra practice] GX2. Write your own second-conditional sentence about what you would take if you went to Mars.

SECTION H — Mixed Review

Complete the sentences with the words from the box. (2 words are extra.)

clip • inches • scientists • research • golden • astronauts • discs

H1. Look at this video _____ of a rocket launch I found. It is really interesting.

H2. One metre is 39.37 _____.

H3. The _____ did a lot of _____ before starting the experiment.

H4. For graduation, my parents gave me a beautiful _____ watch.

H5. _____ must do a lot of training to prepare for living in space.

H6. Do you still have your movies and music on _____? Or are they digital?

Complete the sentences with a compound noun.

H7. Astronauts travel to _____ in rockets.

H8. _____ launch rockets from Earth.

H9. Astronauts return to Earth in a _____.

H10. _____ are different for corn and potatoes.

H11. At night I use _____ from a lamp to do my homework.

H12. In the International Space Station, astronauts live in _____. They float everywhere!

Facts & True/False.

H13. **Did You Know?** How fast must a space rocket go to reach space?

H14. **Did You Know?** How fast does the fastest car in the world go?

H15. In the astronaut crossword, the hidden word (the force that keeps us connected to Earth) is _____.

H16. **True or False:** The corn plant is growing quickly.

H17. **True or False:** The corn plant has enough sunlight, but not enough water.

H18. **True or False:** The potato plants are growing the best.

H19. **True or False:** Mona will eat corn for dinner.

End of questions — Answer Key follows.

ANSWER KEY

*Answers to **[+ extra practice]** items (not from the textbook) are marked **(extra)**. Open-ended writing/speaking tasks are not scored here.*

Section A — Space & Exploration

A1 space **A2** launch **A3** lunar **A4** astronaut **A5** rocket

A6 satellite **A7** land **A8** exploration **A9** capsule

A10 spacesuit **A11** launch pad

Section B — Time Capsules & the Golden Record

B1 d **B2** g **B3** h **B4** a **B5** f **B6** b **B7** e **B8** c

B9 scientists **B10** golden **B11** disc **B12** astronaut **B13** inch **B14** clips **B15** thunderstorms

Section C — Space Journey & Life on Mars

C1 c **C2** a **C3** b **C4** d **C5** e

C6 condition **C7** Extreme **C8** planets **C9** Temperature **C10** climate **C11** weather **C12** gravity

Section D — The Second Conditional

D1 If I went to space, I would take my camera. **D2** Would you go to Mars?

D3 Where would you go if you had a rocket? **D4** I wouldn't go to the sun.

D5 I would be excited if I won a trip to space.

D6 d **D7** c **D8** b **D9** e **D10** a

D11 c **D12** a **D13** b **D14** d

D15 (a) is the first conditional – a real/possible situation; (b) is the second conditional – an imagined/unreal one.

D16 Use *wouldn't* (would + not), e.g. "I wouldn't take my tennis racket."

D17 (Question word +) *would* + subject + base verb, e.g. "If you went to space, what would you take?"

D18 had; would fly (extra) **D19** lived; would grow (extra) **D20** would; do; met (extra)

Section E — Compound Nouns & Noun Phrases

E1 lunar landing = b **E2** air supply = d **E3** sunlight = a **E4** upward = e **E5** spaceflight = c

E6 science experiments **E7** zero gravity **E8** artificial light **E9** outer space

E10 space missions **E11** space station **E12** growing conditions **E13** plant seeds

E14 d (Mars) **E15** e (weather) **E16** b (Red Planet) **E17** c (wind) **E18** a (air)

E19 The moon is very bright tonight. **E20** Mars is a very mysterious planet.

E21 The weather there is very cold. **E22** Mars is also called the Red Planet.

Section F — Reading Comprehension

F1 (c) space travel and (d) living on Mars. **F2** To make his family proud; he likes science fiction and is interested in space exploration.

F3 When we have the best technology and the best people. **F4** Yes – “Of course I would.”

F5 His camera. **F6** Because the gravity is different (sports would be difficult). **F7** Food and seeds (and a notebook).

F8 The International Space Station (ISS). **F9** To conduct science experiments to grow vegetables (like zucchini) in space.

F10 Over 28,000 kilometres per hour. **F11** Two days (a two-day trip). **F12** Zucchini, potatoes, and corn.

F13 Six hours of sunlight and four centimetres of water. **F14** The potatoes.

F15 It got enough sunlight but not enough water. **F16** It got enough water but not enough sunlight.

F17 2055. **F18** It has become over-populated. **F19** To find a home on another planet (Mars).

F20 Explorer One Dubai. **F21** A message about an engine failure on the spaceship.

Section G — Listening (Tracks 7–12)

G1 We did not have the right technology to leave Earth. **G2** Gravity.

G3 Or it will break apart. **G4** Because humans cannot live in space (no air, very cold); to keep astronauts alive.

G5 Sputnik 1, on October 4, 1957. **G6** Laika the dog, on November 3, 1957.

G7 Yuri Gagarin, on April 12, 1961. **G8** Neil Armstrong, on July 20, 1969. **G9** A space satellite.

G10 An audio/visual time capsule, sent in 1977. **G11** 55 languages.

G12 Wind, rain, thunderstorms (also birds, frogs, elephants). **G13** The Taj Mahal, the Sydney Opera House, an airplane, an astronaut (any two).

G14 A tablet. **G15** Because it is the tallest building in the world. **G16** Sheikh Zayed Grand Mosque. **G17** Falconry and camel races.

G18 would. **G19** Explorer One Dubai. **G20** Mars. **G21** Yes, all safe; they ask Mission Control to send help.

G22 a → 3 (Oct 4, 1957) b → 1 (Nov 3, 1957) c → 4 (Apr 12, 1961) d → 2 (Jul 20, 1969)

GX1 1 Sputnik 1 (1957) → 2 Laika (1957) → 3 Gagarin (1961) → 4 Armstrong (1969) → 5 UAE Mars satellite (2021). (extra)

GX2 Answers will vary; e.g. “If I went to Mars, I would take seeds and warm clothes.” (extra)

Section H — Mixed Review

H1 clip **H2** inches **H3** scientists; research **H4** golden **H5** Astronauts **H6** discs

H7 outer space **H8** Rocket engines **H9** space capsule **H10** Growing conditions **H11** artificial light **H12** zero gravity

H13 At least 28,440 km/h. **H14** 490 km/h. **H15** gravity

H16 False (it is growing slowly). **H17** True. **H18** True. **H19** False (she will make the potatoes into French fries).